

 RELOCATION GUIDE

Gold Coast

Yugambah Country

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Gold Coast.

Surf before work. Rainforest at the weekend.

The Gold Coast is the city people think they know from a postcard, then discover has grown into Australia's sixth-largest: around 700,000 people along a single sunny strip of coast, an hour south of Brisbane. Behind the beaches sits a full tertiary teaching hospital that has grown as fast as the skyline, and behind that, a rainforest hinterland you can reach after a day shift.

~700K

people along the coast

57 km

of coastline, Southport
to the border

1 hr

to Brisbane by road or
rail

Regional

for skilled migration

IN THIS GUIDE

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose the Gold Coast

Very few cities let you build a serious hospital career and still live a few streets from the surf. The Gold Coast does, and it is still growing into its potential.



The Gold Coast doesn't ask you to choose between career and lifestyle. It hands you both while the city grows into them.

In the last decade the coast's health system has grown from a modest regional service into a full tertiary teaching campus at Southport, one of the largest hospitals in the country, built beside Griffith University's health and knowledge precinct. A second public campus serves the southern coast, and a large private sector adds depth and choice. For clinicians, that growth means **responsibility and opportunity arrive earlier** than they might in a long-settled system.

Then there is the life around the work. A swim or a walk on the beach before a shift is ordinary routine here, not a holiday treat. Weekends split between the sand and the hinterland: a market, a surf, then a drive up to Tamborine or Springbrook for lunch in cooler air. The pace is pure Queensland: outdoor, unhurried and shaped by the sunshine.

The whole coast is also classed as **regional for skilled migration**, which can open visa pathways the big capitals do not. We will talk you through what that means for your profession and your family.

~700K

people

Australia's sixth-largest city

20 min

inland to
rainforest
and cooler
mountain air

2

universities with
health schools
Griffith and Bond

2018

Commonwealth
Games host
a decade of new
infrastructure

WHAT YOU GAIN

A beach-and-hinterland life

Surf beaches, canals and rainforest within a short drive of each other, all year round.

A system you help shape

Young, expanding departments where your experience is wanted and your ideas are heard.

A teaching culture

University partnerships bring students, trainees and research into the ordinary week.

Easy connections

Light rail along the coast, a train to Brisbane in about an hour, and an airport at the southern end.

GOOD TO KNOW

A city still being built

Cranes and roadworks are part of the scenery; the coast you arrive in will keep improving around you.

A growing specialist bench

A small number of highly specialised cases still go to Brisbane. Ask how your specialty fits.

A car is useful

The light rail serves the coastal strip beautifully; the hinterland and western suburbs are easier with a car.

Warm, humid summers

Summer is hot and stormy. Winter, mild and sunny, is the season the locals love most.

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It suits you best if...

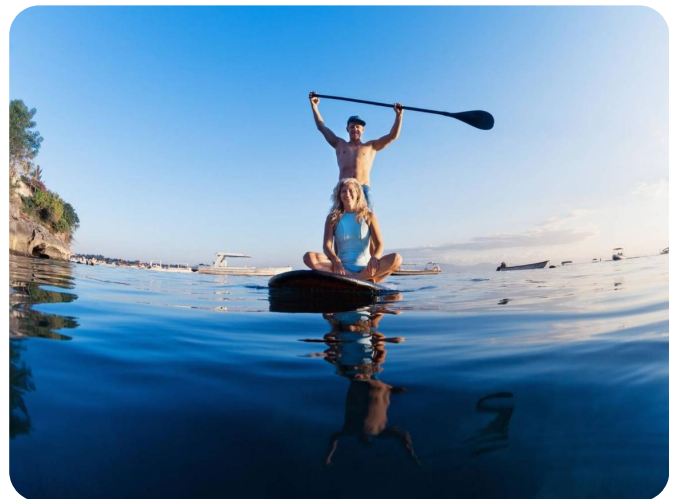
If you're looking for an established inner-city culture or a crisp four-season climate, the Gold Coast may not be it; Brisbane, an hour north, has more of the former. If you're drawn to the outdoors, a growing hospital where you can make your mark, and a home near the water, it could be a wonderful choice.



World-class surf is part of everyday life on the coast



Surfing with friends: a favourite way to start the day



Calm water mornings on a paddleboard



The beach in the middle of the city



Family days on the sand



Brunch after a morning swim

The Gold Coast at a glance

A single coastal strip with a rainforest spine behind it, built quickly and still building, on the land of the Yugambeh-speaking peoples.

The Gold Coast runs about 57 kilometres from the Broadwater at Southport, in the north, to Coolangatta on the New South Wales border. Between them sit high-rise beachfronts at Surfers Paradise and Broadbeach, relaxed surf suburbs such as Burleigh Heads and Palm Beach, and a maze of canal estates behind the beach. Inland, newer suburbs climb towards the green ridges of the hinterland: Tamborine Mountain, Springbrook and Lamington, part of the Gondwana Rainforests of Australia World Heritage Area.

It is a young, energetic city. A steady stream of Australians move here from Sydney and Melbourne each year, drawn by the lifestyle, and Griffith and Bond universities bring a lively student population. Tourism, health and construction are the coast's biggest employers, and the 2018 Commonwealth Games left a legacy of new infrastructure, including the light rail.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Hot and humid, around 21–29°C, with afternoon storms and the warmest sea of the year. Worth planning around the occasional ex-tropical weather system.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Warm and easing, around 17–25°C, with drier air and still-warm water. Many locals' favourite swimming season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild, sunny and dry, around 10–21°C. Blue-sky days and whale season offshore; this is when visitors flock here.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Warming up, around 16–25°C, with humidity building and the hinterland at its greenest.



A note on Country

The Gold Coast sits on the land of the Yugambeh-speaking peoples, including the Kombumerri clan group. Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings and events across the region, and taking time to learn whose Country you are on is warmly appreciated. The Yugambeh Museum at Beenleigh, just north of the coast, is a good place to start.



The coast from the air: river, towers and surf side by side



Evening light over the beachfront towers

Who lives here

- ✓ A young, growing population, with plenty of working-age arrivals and young families.
- ✓ Two university communities that keep the coast lively and outward-looking.
- ✓ Many interstate movers from Sydney and Melbourne, so you will not be the only newcomer at the barbecue.
- ✓ Growing Indian, Filipino, South African, New Zealand and British communities, with a warm welcome for newcomers.



Golden-hour light in the Queensland countryside

Healthcare and work on the Gold Coast

Registration is national; the opportunity here is local and fast-moving. The coast's health system has grown from a regional service into a full tertiary teaching campus in barely a decade.

Queensland runs its public hospitals through regional hospital and health services, and one service covers the whole coast. Its flagship is the tertiary teaching hospital at Southport: one of the largest hospitals in Australia, sitting within a health and knowledge precinct alongside Griffith University's medical, nursing and allied health schools. A second public hospital at Robina serves the southern coast, alongside community health, mental health and outreach services.

Around the public system is a large private sector, with several major private hospitals along the strip and busy private imaging, pathology, rehabilitation and allied health practices. Just over the border, a new regional hospital in the Tweed serves the northern New South Wales coast, which can widen your options if you live at the southern end.



A newborn check

SOUTHPORT · NORTHERN COAST

The tertiary campus

A full tertiary teaching hospital with emergency, trauma, cancer, cardiac, maternity, paediatric and intensive care services, and a university precinct next door.

ROBINA · CENTRAL-SOUTH

The southern campus

A second public hospital serving the fast-growing southern suburbs, easing pressure on the tertiary centre.

ALONG THE STRIP

The private sector

Several major private hospitals and day surgeries, plus large imaging and pathology providers, add real depth and choice.

ACROSS THE COAST

Community and outreach

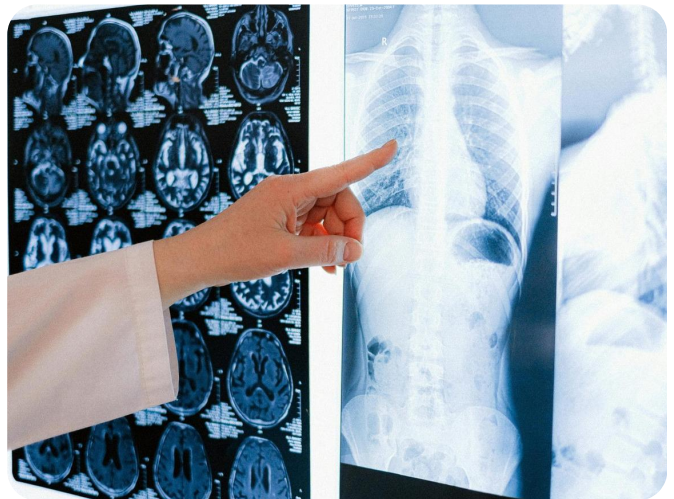
Community health, mental health, aged care and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander health services reach the whole city.

What makes practice here different is the pace. New departments need senior people, so roles open here that a settled system would fill from within. Services still forming are services you can influence. The Griffith partnership, and Bond University's medical school at Robina, mean teaching and research are part of the normal week.

Worth planning for: the specialist bench is still growing alongside the population it serves, and a small number of highly specialised tertiary cases are referred to Brisbane. If your field is very narrow, tell us early and we will help you understand how the local service fits.



In theatre



Imaging and allied health are busy across public and private services

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which campus, and which team? The tertiary campus and the southern campus sit at opposite ends of the coast.
- ☐ How is the department growing, and what new services are planned in the next few years?
- ☐ Which cases are referred to Brisbane, and how is that handled day to day?
- ☐ What teaching and research involvement comes with the university partnerships?
- ☐ What does the roster look like: shift patterns, on-call frequency and how gaps are covered?
- ☐ What funded CPD time and support is there, and can I salary-package part of my pay?
- ☐ What orientation and supervision is there for clinicians trained overseas?



Nursing teams are growing with the coast



Paediatric and rehabilitation work across the coast



Primary care and outpatient clinics



Theatres at both public campuses



A young population means busy maternity services

Where to live on the Gold Coast

The coast runs from high-rise beachfront to canal estates to hinterland acreage, often within a few kilometres. Choose your hospital first, then the kind of day you want around it.

**~5–15 MIN TO THE TERTIARY CAMPUS ·
BROADWATER**

Southport, Labrador & Biggera Waters

Close to the tertiary campus and the light rail, with parks and paddling on the calm Broadwater. Practical, central and handy for shift work.

~15–20 MIN · BEACH AND LIGHT RAIL

Surfers Paradise & Broadbeach

Apartment living with the beach, restaurants and the light rail at the door. Lively, especially in peak season; ideal for singles and couples.

~25 MIN · CAFÉS AND SURF

Burleigh, Miami & Mermaid Beach

The coast's favourite beach suburbs: cafés, a headland national park and a relaxed village feel, now with the light rail at Burleigh. Popular with professionals and young families.

~15–25 MIN · WATER AT THE BACK FENCE

Canal estates

Sorrento, Mermaid Waters and Broadbeach Waters: family homes with a jetty and a kayak, a true Gold Coast signature.

**~10 MIN TO THE SOUTHERN CAMPUS ·
SCHOOLS**

Robina & Varsity Lakes

Planned, leafy suburbs near Bond University, with lakes, parks, good schools and the train to Brisbane.

**~10 MIN TO THE AIRPORT · QUIETER
BEACHES**

Palm Beach, Currumbin & Coolangatta

Slower-paced southern beach towns near the border and the airport. Lovely for families; allow longer to reach the northern hospital.

~20–30 MIN · NEW ESTATES

Hope Island, Coomera & the northern corridor

Fast-growing suburbs with new homes, schools and shopping, on the train line towards Brisbane.

~30–45 MIN · SPACE AND COOLER AIR

The hinterland

Tamborine Mountain, Mudgeeraba, Bonogin and the Currumbin Valley: acreage, rainforest views and cooler nights. A car is essential.

The housing market has grown quickly as the coast has become more popular, so it is no longer the bargain it once was, though it generally still offers more space for your money than Sydney. On the open market you apply with ID, references and proof of income, then pay a bond (usually four weeks' rent) that is lodged with Queensland's Residential Tenancies Authority.

Many newcomers rent short-term near their hospital for the first few months, explore a few suburbs at the weekend, and then sign a longer lease once they know which end of the coast feels like home.



Canal-front living, with a jetty at the end of the garden



Low-rise beach suburbs, a short walk from the sand



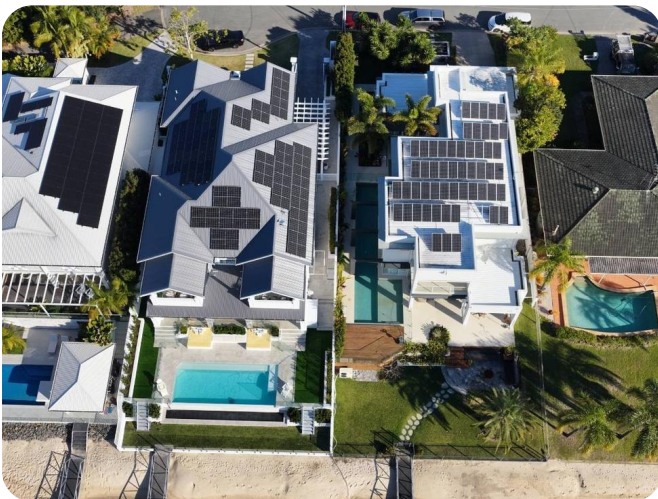
Family streets with backyards and pools

Choosing your area, in order

- ☐ Fix your work site first: the tertiary campus at Southport and the southern campus at Robina sit at opposite ends of the strip.
- ☐ Check state school catchments for the exact address if you have children; growing suburbs can have busy schools.
- ☐ Decide how much you value beach access versus space and a garden, and test both before you buy.
- ☐ Look at the light rail and train lines; living near a stop makes daily life very easy.
- ☐ Rent short-term first, then commit once you know the coast.



Verandahs and shade: the classic Queensland home, built for the climate



Waterfront homes with pools, a south-east Queensland favourite



Evenings on the deck, under a Queensland sunset

Getting around the Gold Coast

The Gold Coast is easier to get around than its length suggests: a light rail runs along the coastal strip, the train links you to Brisbane, and the airport is at the southern end.

HELENSVALE TO BURLEIGH HEADS

G:link light rail

Trams run the length of the coastal strip, from the train at Helensvale through Southport, the tertiary campus, Surfers Paradise and Broadbeach to Burleigh Heads, where the newest extension opened in 2026.

~1 HR TO BRISBANE

The train

The Gold Coast line runs from Varsity Lakes through Robina, Nerang and Helensvale to Brisbane and on to Brisbane Airport.

ACROSS THE COAST

Buses

Buses link the suburbs with the light rail and train stations. One go card, or a contactless bank card, works across the whole south-east Queensland Translink network.

HINTERLAND AND WESTERN SUBURBS

Driving

Most households run a car. The M1 to Brisbane is busy on weekends and holidays, so the train is often the relaxed choice.

FROM THE CENTRAL COAST TO	ROUGHLY	HOW
End to end on the light rail	~1 hr	G:link, Helensvale to Burleigh Heads
The tertiary campus at Southport	~10–20 min	Light rail, bus or car
The southern campus at Robina	~15–20 min	Car, bus or train
Gold Coast Airport, Coolangatta	~30 min	Car or bus
The hinterland	~45 min	Car
Brisbane CBD	~1 hr – 1 hr 15	Train or the M1
Brisbane Airport	~1 hr 30	Train (direct) or car



The G:link light rail runs along the coastal strip



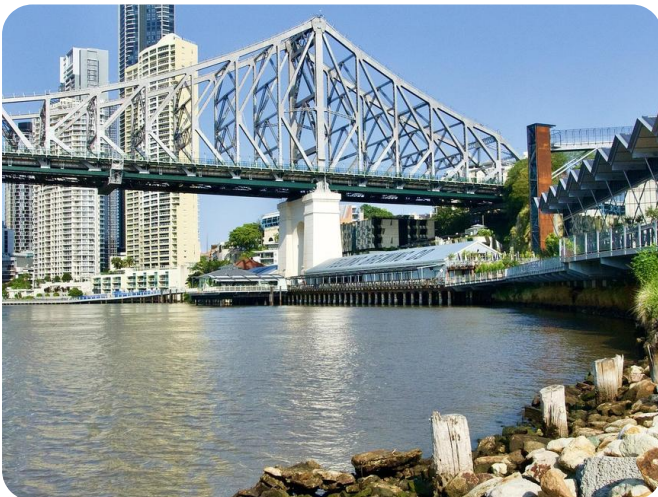
Brisbane's city centre, about an hour north by train

Gold Coast Airport at Coolangatta has domestic flights across Australia and services to New Zealand, the Pacific and Asia, and Brisbane Airport covers the wider international network. Living near a light rail stop or train station can make the car optional for the daily commute; for the hinterland and weekend adventures, a car remains the easiest way to go.

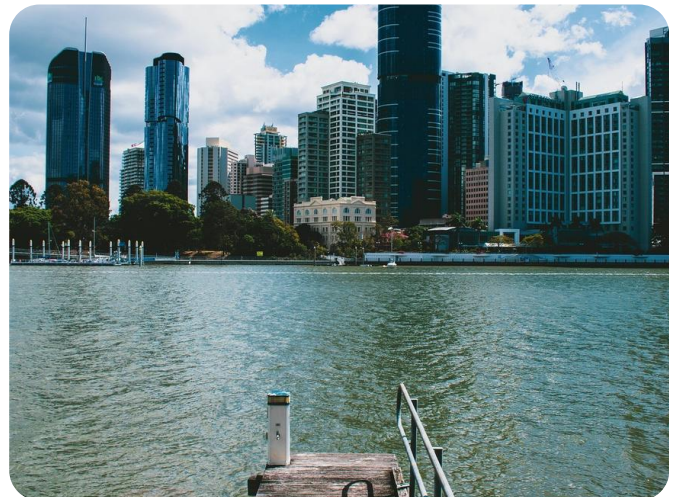
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Sophie's tip

If you can live and work near a light rail stop, do; it changes daily life here. If your role is in the western suburbs or you love the hinterland, plan on a car from the start, and take the train rather than the M1 on long weekends.



Brisbane's Story Bridge: the capital is an easy train ride north



Brisbane's riverside, about an hour from the coast by train

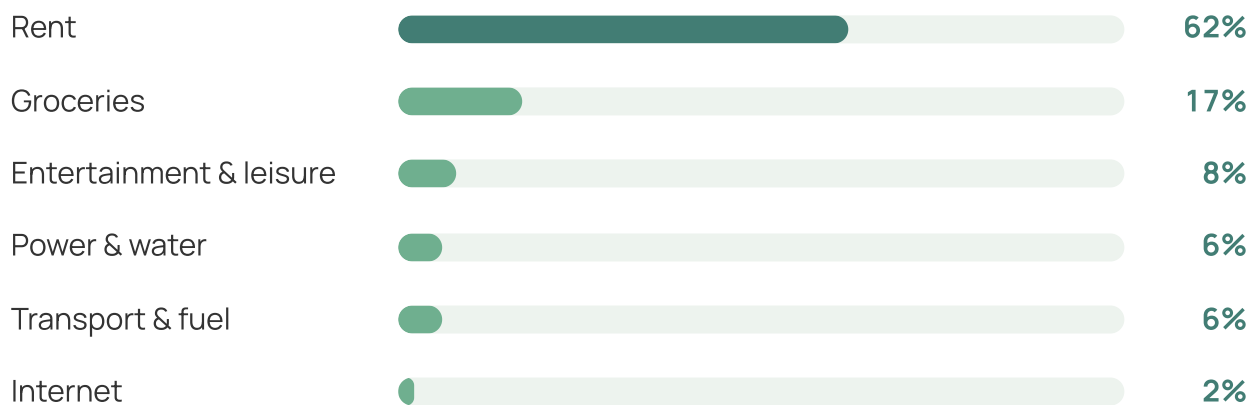
What it costs to live here

The Gold Coast sits between the big southern capitals and the rest of Queensland: no longer the bargain it once was, but generally more space and sunshine for your money than Sydney or Melbourne.

Housing is the line that decides it. Rent takes the largest share of a monthly budget here, and the suburb you choose does most of the work: an apartment beside the light rail, a canal-side family home and a hinterland cottage can feel like three different cities. Everyday costs such as groceries, eating out and running a car are broadly in line with the rest of south-east Queensland.

We deliberately do not print prices, because figures date quickly. Use the live calculators in the directory at the back of this guide to compare the Gold Coast with the city you are leaving; that comparison is the one that really counts.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest share, so the suburb you choose matters most.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Summer cooling. Air conditioning shows up on the power bill for a few months; shade, fans and a breezy home help, and there is no winter heating bill to speak of.
- ✓ Home and contents insurance. Storm cover can cost more in Queensland than in the southern states, so get a quote for the address early.
- ✓ The move itself: a rental bond, rent in advance, temporary accommodation and setting up a home.
- ✓ A car, and possibly tolls. Most households have one, and some routes towards Brisbane use toll roads.
- ✓ School holidays and Schoolies week in November. Short-term rentals book up and prices rise, so arrange first accommodation early.



A traditional Queensland timber home, built for the climate



A backyard pool with the skyline beyond

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary you can live very comfortably here, with the beach and the hinterland free to enjoy.
- ✓ Choose your suburb with care: it shapes your budget more than anything else.
- ✓ Ask payroll about salary packaging from day one; many public roles offer it and it makes a real difference.
- ✓ Pay and allowances vary by role and agreement, so ask us and we will talk you through the range for your profession.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about the Gold Coast

People know the Gold Coast for the beaches, but what surprises clinicians is how much the health sector has grown. There is real career opportunity here now, not just a lovely lifestyle. I have watched candidates arrive expecting a beach suburb and find a genuine, ambitious health system instead, and the chance to help build it.

My advice is to come curious about a city that is still finding its feet, and to think about how much you value an established specialist bench versus fast-moving opportunity. For most families, though, it is one of the easiest 'yes' decisions on the whole east coast: surf in the morning, rainforest at the weekend, and sunshine on almost every day of the year.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



On the coast, surfing is for every age

Food, markets and the everyday

Food on the Gold Coast runs from beachside brunch to hinterland farm gates, and the dining scene is maturing as fast as everything else here.

Burleigh Heads is the coast's best-known dining strip, with breakfast culture, cafés and some of its most-loved restaurants. Miami Marketta's night markets bring street food and live music, and Broadbeach, Mermaid Beach and Palm Beach all have their own café streets. Fresh seafood comes straight from local co-ops and fish markets, and the hinterland adds wineries, cheese, fudge and farm-gate produce on Tamborine Mountain.

Woolworths and Coles cover the full range across the coast, ALDI is the go-to for a good-value weekly shop, and IGA and independents fill in around the edges. Indian, Asian, African and Pacific grocers are spread across Southport, Nerang, Robina and the northern suburbs, and there are halal butchers and a growing choice of international restaurants.



Weekend brunch is a coast-wide ritual



The flat white: Australia's everyday coffee



Indian and South Asian food is easy to find

LOCAL SLANG

The Goldy

The affectionate nickname most Australians use for the Gold Coast.

SURFERS PARADISE

The Strip

The beachfront core of Surfers Paradise, around Cavill Avenue.

PACIFIC MOTORWAY

The M1

The motorway to Brisbane, and everyone's favourite topic on a long weekend.

UP THE RANGE

The Hinterland

The rainforest country behind the coast: Tamborine, Springbrook and Lamington.

NOVEMBER

Schoolies

The school-leavers' celebration on the coast each November; good to know when booking accommodation.

Finding your community

- ✓ A Syro-Malabar Catholic mission, Catholic and Anglican parishes, Pentecostal churches, a purpose-built mosque and Hindu temples, including a new mandir.
- ✓ Kerala, Indian, Filipino, African and South African community groups that hold festivals, sport and family events.
- ✓ Surf lifesaving clubs, parkrun, sports clubs and beach volunteers: the quickest way to make friends here.
- ✓ Free English classes and settlement support through multicultural services on the coast.



Sophie's tip

Book ahead for Burleigh's better-known cafés at the weekend; the coast's food reputation is well and truly out, and the queues prove it.

What people do at the weekend

Weekends here mean the beach in the morning, the hinterland in the afternoon, and sport, markets and wildlife in between.

Most weekends start on the sand. Patrolled beaches stretch the length of the coast, the Burleigh Head National Park walk has a beach at either end, and the calm Broadwater at Southport is where families paddle, fish and picnic. In winter, whales pass close offshore and whale-watching boats run from the Broadwater.

The hinterland is the coast's best-kept secret: rainforest, waterfalls and cool mountain air close enough for an after-work drive. And there is plenty on in town, from the theme parks to Gold Coast Suns AFL and Titans rugby league games, surf competitions and festivals.

A typical Gold Coast weekend

- ✓ An early swim or surf, then breakfast at a beachside café.
- ✓ A drive up to Tamborine Mountain for the galleries, wineries and lookouts.
- ✓ Miami Marketta or a farmers' market on a Saturday night.
- ✓ Nippers (junior surf lifesaving) or club sport on Saturday morning.
- ✓ A rainforest walk at Springbrook, ending at a waterfall lookout.
- ✓ A barbecue in a beachfront park as the sun goes down.

~20 MIN

Burleigh Head National Park

A short headland walk through rainforest and pandanus, with surf views and a beach at each end.

~45 MIN

Tamborine Mountain

Villages, galleries, wineries, a rainforest skywalk and lookouts over the coast.

~45 MIN – 1 HR

Springbrook National Park

Ancient rainforest and waterfalls, including Purling Brook Falls, with glow-worms after dark.

~45 MIN

Natural Bridge

A rock arch over a waterfall pool and a famous glow-worm cave, lovely on an evening walk.



Rainbow Bay at the southern end of the coast



Koalas: wildlife sanctuaries are a weekend favourite



Game day at the AFL stadium in Carrara

~1 HR 30

Lamington National Park

Rainforest walks, treetop walkways and birdlife at Green Mountains (O'Reilly's) and Binna Burra.

~25 MIN

Currumbin Wildlife Sanctuary

Koalas, kangaroos and the famous lorikeet feeding, right in the southern suburbs.

~20-30 MIN

The theme parks

Sea World, Movie World, Dreamworld and Wet'n'Wild: a rite of passage for visiting family.

~20 MIN

Game day at Carrara

AFL at the coast's big stadium, plus rugby league at Robina.

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Good to know

Hinterland roads wind more than GPS estimates suggest, so allow extra time. Waterfalls are at their best after rain, so check park conditions before a special trip, and always swim between the red and yellow flags on the beach.

Around the Gold Coast

The Gold Coast sits in one of Australia's most beautiful corners: World Heritage rainforest behind it, Byron Bay and the Tweed just over the border, Brisbane an hour north and the sand islands of Moreton Bay beyond.

Cross the border at Coolangatta and you are in the Tweed, in New South Wales: the river town of Murwillumbah, quieter beaches at Kingscliff and Cabarita, and the Northern Rivers Rail Trail through green farmland. Further south, Byron Bay has its lighthouse walk, surf and laid-back town centre, under an hour and a half away. One quirk worth knowing: Queensland does not use daylight saving, so in summer the clocks on the New South Wales side are an hour ahead.

North is Brisbane, Queensland's capital, for concerts, galleries, international flights and specialist shopping. Beyond it lies Moreton Bay, where ferries from Cleveland reach North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah) with its gorges, dolphins and whale-watching headlands. South Stradbroke Island is right on the doorstep, a short boat trip across the Broadwater. For snow, coast people hop on a short flight south to the Victorian Alps or the Snowy Mountains.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
The nearest beach	a few minutes	Patrolled surf beaches run the whole length of the coast, and many suburbs are a walk from the sand. Swim between the flags.
Ski fields (Snowy Mountains or Victorian Alps)	a short flight south	Fly to Sydney, Canberra or Melbourne and drive on; a classic winter break from June to September, snow permitting.
Brisbane	~1 hr by car or train	Queensland's capital: galleries, concerts, South Bank, major hospitals and international flights.
Gold Coast Airport, Coolangatta	~30 min	Domestic flights across Australia, plus services to New Zealand, the Pacific and Asia.
Byron Bay	~1 hr – 1 hr 30	The lighthouse walk, surf, dolphins and a relaxed town over the New South Wales border.
The Tweed and Murwillumbah	~30–45 min	River towns, quiet beaches, a regional art gallery and the Northern Rivers Rail Trail.
Springbrook, Tamborine & Lamington	~45 min – 1 hr 30	World Heritage rainforest, waterfalls, lookouts and mountain villages.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
North Stradbroke Island	~1 hr 15 + ferry	Point Lookout's gorge walk, surf beaches, dolphins and winter whales.

~1 HR - 1 HR 30 · NEW SOUTH WALES

Byron Bay

Walk to the lighthouse at Australia's most easterly point, then swim at Wategos.

~45 MIN · THE TWEED

Murwillumbah & the rail trail

Cycle the Northern Rivers Rail Trail, then visit the Tweed Regional Gallery.

~1 HR · BY TRAIN

Brisbane

South Bank, the galleries and museum, and the riverside CityCats.

A LONG DAY OR A WEEKEND

North Stradbroke Island

Point Lookout's gorge walk, with turtles, dolphins and winter whales offshore.

BY BOAT FROM THE BROADWATER

South Stradbroke Island

Quiet beaches, camping and wallabies, right across the water from Southport.

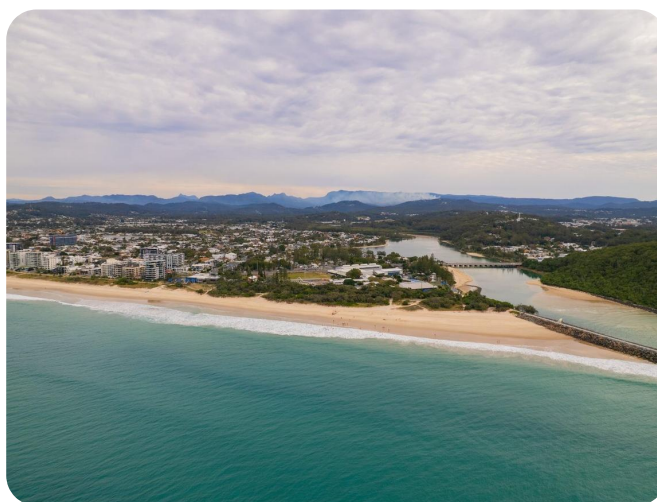
A WEEKEND · VIA BRISBANE

Moreton Island

Sand dunes, snorkelling around the Tangalooma wrecks and a relaxed island resort.



Tweed Heads, where Queensland meets New South Wales



Tallebudgera Creek on the southern Gold Coast, calm water beside the surf



Brisbane, Queensland's capital, about an hour north



Moreton Island, across the bay from Brisbane



Brisbane's South Bank, an hour north of the coast

Families and schools

The Gold Coast is a wonderful place to grow up: outdoors all year, with beaches, nippers, parks and wildlife, and a wide choice of state, Catholic and independent schools.



Learning to surf is part of growing up on the coast



Calm creek mouths are ideal for little swimmers

Queensland schooling starts with Prep, a full-time year children begin when they turn five by 30 June. Primary school runs from Prep to Year 6 and secondary school from Year 7 to Year 12, across four terms a year, finishing with the Queensland Certificate of Education (QCE).

Most children attend state schools run by the Queensland Department of Education, and the coast has large, well-established state high schools in every corridor. Alongside them are Catholic schools and independent schools, many faith-based, which charge fees; long-established independent schools such as The Southport School and St Hilda's sit alongside newer colleges in the growth suburbs.

State schools have catchment areas, and schools near capacity run enrolment management plans, so living in the catchment guarantees a place at your local school. Check the catchment for the exact address before you sign a lease.

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School fees for temporary visa holders

Queensland generally enrolls the children of skilled employer-sponsored visa holders (such as the 482 and 494) in state schools without tuition fees, while some other temporary visas are fee-paying. Confirm your visa subclass with the Department of Education's international unit (DE International), which publishes the list of visa subclasses and enrolment conditions. School levies, uniforms and excursions still apply.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Nippers on Sunday mornings at the local surf lifesaving club.
- ✓ Rock pools, creek mouths and the calm Broadwater parklands at Southport.
- ✓ Club sport all year: swimming, football, netball, cricket, AFL and rugby league.
- ✓ Currumbin Wildlife Sanctuary, Sea World and the other theme parks.
- ✓ Glow-worms and waterfalls in the hinterland.
- ✓ Learning to swim early, at school and at the local pool.



After the bell: outdoor learning and play suit the climate



Free kindy is available in the year before Prep

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Early childhood

Queensland funds free kindy, up to 15 hours a week, in approved kindergarten programmes in the year before Prep. Long day care and family day care are widely available; many families on temporary visas are not eligible for the federal Child Care Subsidy, so ask about fees and waitlists early.

GOLD COAST CAMPUS, SOUTHPORT

Griffith University

A large public university with medicine, nursing, dentistry and allied health beside the coast's health and knowledge precinct.

ROBINA

Bond University

Australia's first private university, known for its medical programme and small classes.

COOLANGATTA

Southern Cross University

A campus by the airport, with nursing, health and education courses.

CAMPUSES ACROSS THE COAST

TAFE Queensland

Vocational training and English courses, including pathways into health and community services.



Paddling, swimming and sailing: water confidence starts young



Creative play at kindy and school



Meeting the locals at a wildlife sanctuary



Senior school: clear pathways to university and vocational training

“

**Surf in the morning, rainforest at the weekend,
and a career that grows with the city.**

Your Gold Coast address book

The Gold Coast's communities are growing as fast as the city. A Syro-Malabar Catholic mission at Nerang brings the Kerala community together each week, the coast has its own purpose-built mosque, a new Hindu mandir and a Hindu cultural precinct under construction, and a regional multicultural council offers free English classes and settlement support. Brisbane's larger communities, temples and grocers are an hour north.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

City of Gold Coast

Rubbish and recycling, libraries, parks, pools, pet registration, lifeguards and city events

goldcoast.qld.gov.au

Scenic Rim Regional Council

Tamborine Mountain and the hinterland villages behind the coast

scenicrim.qld.gov.au

Tweed Shire Council

Tweed Heads, Kingscliff and Murwillumbah, just over the New South Wales border

tweed.nsw.gov.au

GETTING AROUND & HEALTH ADVICE

Translink

Light rail, trains and buses across south-east Queensland, the go card and the journey planner

13 12 30 translink.com.au

Gold Coast Airport

Flights, parking and transport to and from the airport at Coolangatta

goldcoastairport.com.au

13 HEALTH

Queensland's 24/7 health advice line, staffed by registered nurses

13 43 25 84 qld.gov.au/health

Queensland Government

Driver licences, vehicle registration, schools and state services in one place

qld.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Multicultural Communities Council Gold Coast (MCCGC)

The coast's peak multicultural organisation: settlement support, free English classes, employment help, community connection and cultural programmes. Level 1, 60 High Street, Southport.

07 5620 3900 mccgc.org.au

Mary Matha Syro-Malabar Mission, Gold Coast

The centre of the Gold Coast's Kerala Catholic community, with Malayalam Holy Qurbana, catechism and family units across the coast's suburbs.

marymathagoldcoast.org.au

Malayalee Association of Queensland (MAQ)

Brisbane-based Kerala association for the whole state: Onam, Christmas and Kerala festivals, sport and social gatherings.

facebook.com/MalayaleeAssociationofQueensland

Nigerian Community Association Queensland

Statewide Nigerian community association with a Gold Coast branch: networking, family picnics, sports days and social events.

nigeriansinqld.org.au

Gold Coast Hindu Cultural Association

Music, dance, bhajans, language classes and festivals such as Navaratri, and the Hindu cultural precinct being built at Helensvale.

goldcoasthindu.org

Filipino Catholic Community, Archdiocese of Brisbane

Filipino-community Masses on set weekends at parishes including Southport; a warm way to meet Filipino families.

multiculturalcare.org.au/diversity/filipino-catholic-community

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Southport Catholic Parish

Catholic parish in central Southport; the Archdiocese of Brisbane website has Mass times and a parish finder for the whole coast.

brisbanecatholic.org.au

St Brigid's Catholic Parish, Nerang

Catholic parish at 39–49 McLaren Road, Nerang, which also hosts the Syro-Malabar mission's Malayalam Masses.

stbrigidsparishnerang.org.au

St Peter's Anglican Church, Southport

Anglican parish in the classical tradition, at 83 Nerang Street, Southport.

stpetersgc.org.au

King's Church (Pentecostal)

Large Pentecostal church (Australian Christian Churches) with campuses across the coast, including Reedy Creek, Pimpama, the Broadwater and Tweed Heads.

kings.org.au

Greek Orthodox Church of St Anna

Greek Orthodox parish and community centre serving the Gold Coast and northern New South Wales.

gocstanna.org

Gold Coast Mosque (Islamic Society of Gold Coast)

The coast's purpose-built mosque, with a resident imam, Friday prayers and community activities. 144 Allied Drive, Arundel.

goldcoastmasjid.org.au

BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Mandir, Gold Coast

Hindu mandir inaugurated on the Gold Coast in 2025; contact BAPS for the address and programmes.

baps.org

Gold Coast Hebrew Congregation (Bet Shlomo)

Synagogue in Surfers Paradise serving the coast's Jewish community.

Temple Shalom

Progressive Jewish congregation on the Isle of Capri, Gold Coast.

Fo Guang Shan Chung Tian Temple (Buddhist)

Large Buddhist temple and cultural centre with gardens at Priestdale in Logan, about 40 minutes north of the coast.

fgschungtian.org.au

Brisbane Sikh Temple (Gurdwara)

The region's main gurdwara, at 2679 Logan Road, Eight Mile Plains, about 50 minutes north of the coast.

brisbanesikh temple.org.au

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Gold Coast Chinatown, Southport

Asian restaurants and shops around Davenport and Young Streets, beside the Southport light rail station, with Chinese New Year celebrations and street markets.

Brisbane's south side

For the widest choice of Indian, Asian and halal grocers, many families make a monthly trip to Sunnybank, Kuraby and Logan, about 45 minutes north.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with stores across the coast; online ordering and delivery.

woolworths.com.au

Coles

National supermarket chain with stores across the coast; online ordering and delivery.

[coles.com.au](https://www.coles.com.au)

ALDI

Discount supermarket, popular for the weekly shop.

[aldi.com.au](https://www.aldi.com.au)

Carrara Markets

Australia's largest permanent market: over 300 stalls, food and family attractions, every Saturday and Sunday from 8am to 3pm. Corner of Gooding Drive and Manchester Road, Carrara.

07 5579 9388 [carraramarkets.com.au](https://www.carraramarkets.com.au)

Miami Marketta

The coast's much-loved night market, with street food from around the world and live music, at 23 Hillcrest Parade, Miami.

[miamimarketta.com](https://www.miamimarketta.com)

HOTA Farmers Markets

Sunday morning farmers' market at the Home of the Arts, 135 Bundall Road, Surfers Paradise.

Marina Mirage Farmers Market

Saturday morning farmers' market at Marina Mirage, Main Beach, beside the Broadwater.

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

Queensland Schools Directory

Find state schools by name, suburb and type, with links to each school's website and catchment information.

schoolsdirectory.eq.edu.au

DE International (Queensland Department of Education)

Enrolment rules and fees for children of temporary visa holders at Queensland state schools; check your visa subclass here before you enrol.

education.qld.gov.au

School uniforms

Most Queensland state schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop, often run by the school's P&C association; ask the school about opening hours and second-hand uniforms.

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

Rentals and homes for sale across the Gold Coast.

[realestate.com.au](https://www.realestate.com.au)

Domain

Rentals and homes for sale across the Gold Coast.

[domain.com.au](https://www.domain.com.au)

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and house-shares, useful for the first few months.

[flatmates.com.au](https://www.flatmates.com.au)

Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)

Queensland's renting authority: holds rental bonds and runs a free dispute resolution service.

[rta.qld.gov.au](https://www.rta.qld.gov.au)

Tenants Queensland

Free statewide tenancy advice and advocacy for renters.

1300 744 263 [tenantsqld.org.au](https://www.tenantsqld.org.au)

GETTING AROUND

Translink

G:link light rail, trains and buses across south-east Queensland: the go card, contactless payment, fares and the journey planner.

13 12 30 [translink.com.au](https://www.translink.com.au)

Gold Coast Airport

Flights, parking and transport to and from the airport at Coolangatta.

[goldcoastairport.com.au](https://www.goldcoastairport.com.au)

Queensland Government: overseas and interstate licences

How to drive on, and transfer, an overseas licence in Queensland (Department of Transport and Main Roads).

[qld.gov.au/transport/licensing/driver-licensing/overseas](https://www.qld.gov.au/transport/licensing/driver-licensing/overseas)

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo: Gold Coast

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living data; compare the Gold Coast with the city you are leaving.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Gold-Coast

Expatistan

A second side-by-side cost-of-living comparison.

expatistan.com

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official figures on prices, rents and household spending.

abs.gov.au

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 ahpra.gov.au

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition

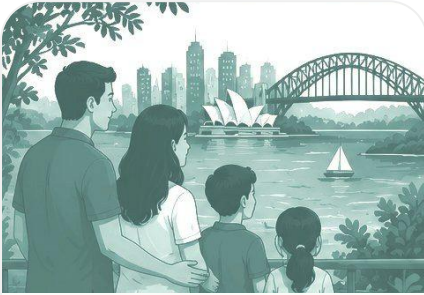


Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

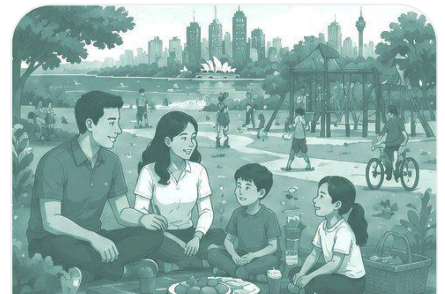
We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

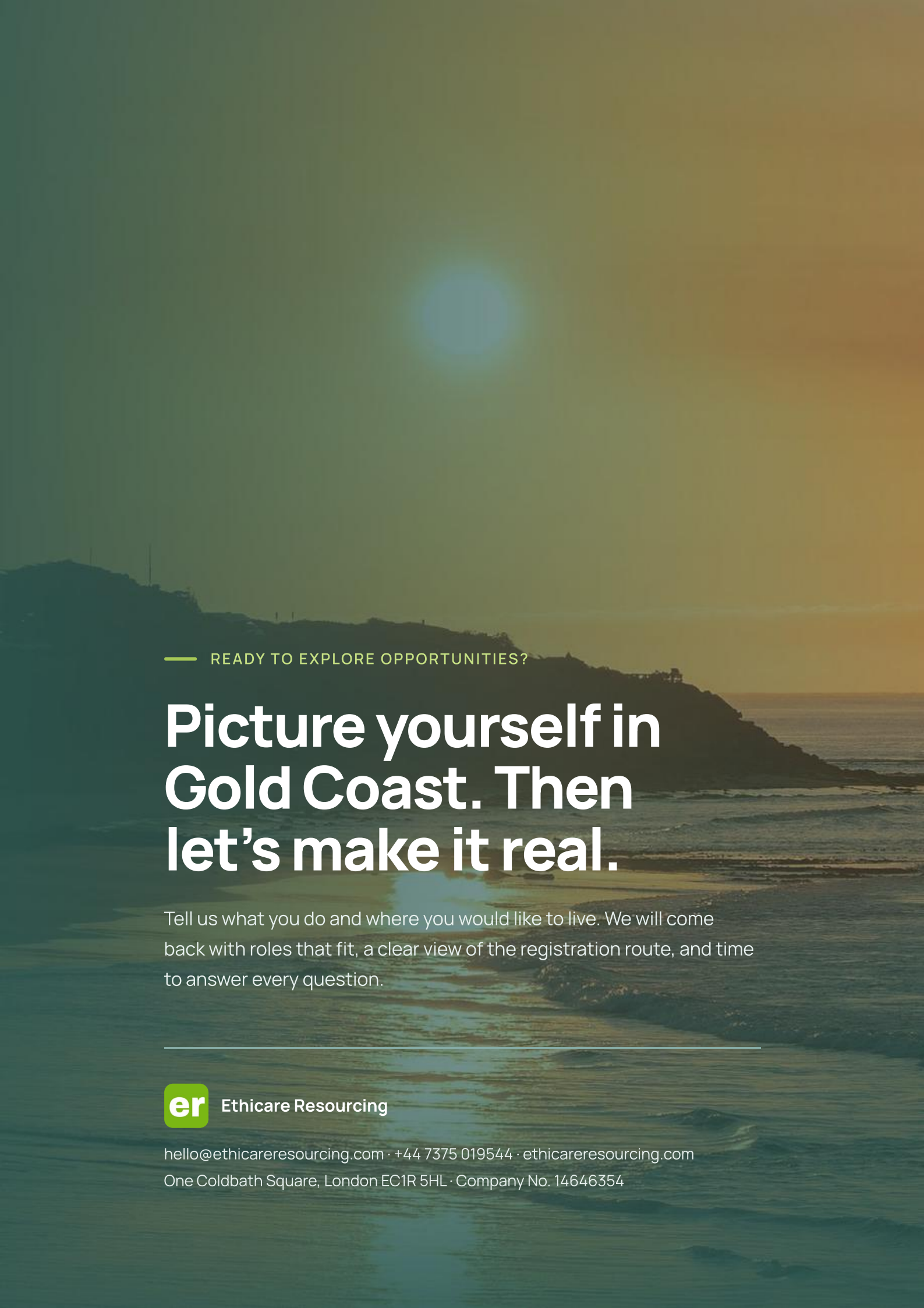
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Gold Coast. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354